

Radar

The concept of using sound waves to gauge the distance of objects around you was a well kept secret in the bat-circle till Lazarro Spallanzan, in 1793, figured it out when he studied the ability of blind bats to navigate using ultra-sound and from there the initial concept of SONAR was born, which eventually gave way to RADAR, without any credit given to the bats.

With the Titanic disaster, the need for finding an effective anti-collision system spurred research on RADAR as a system. Robert Watson, a Scottish physicist, felt that its applications could also be found in war and so designed the first practical RADAR system. This was used by Great Britain in World War II for aerial surveillance and is touted to be one of the reasons for their success. Funnily enough, the Germans had also built their own air defence system at the same time called the Kammhuber Line.

Radar finds use in navigation of ships and planes, by the police for catching speeding automobiles and controlling traffic, prediction of the weather, tracking of migratory patterns of birds, and of course by the military which uses it for tracking or gunning down unwanted elements.

Radio Transmission

While some say that it was Nikola Tesla who invented the radio, others say it was Guglielmo Marconi. But the best version of these stories is that our own Jagadish Chandra Bose was the one who invented it. JCB demonstrated radio transmission in 1896 in Calcutta in front of the British Governor General and had solved the problem of waves not travelling through walls or water through his 'Mercury Coherer with a telephone detector' device. Marconi's Coherer, which he used in 1901, was an exact replica of it. The story goes that Marconi stole JCB's notebook in which the Mercury Coherer was drawn, and so when asked how he came up with the design, he fumbled like

